Look up the route. Find the next hop.

3-5 players / About 25-35 minutes / 8 rounds

NETWORK COURIER

One action per turn: send a packet or change a route.

1 Deliver orders to score

Send packets from network A to B, C or D. Orders for B and D score 3 points; C orders score 5. After eight rounds, the highest score wins. Tied players share victory. Unsent and undelivered orders score zero. There is no speed bonus.

2 Set up the shared network

Give each player a mat, one Route Flip Card and two packet tokens. Shuffle 24 orders and deal two to each player. Set out the board, four queues and four routing tables. Initially, R1 routes D traffic to R2. All other entries are fixed. Set round 1 and choose a starting player at random.

3 Keep the board state visible

Unsent orders are private. In-transit orders and all routing tables are public. Tokens at a router are waiting to join a queue. Queued tokens are still at the sending router. Record each packet number and current router on its order. Each player may have at most two packets in transit.

PRINT CHECKLIST

Pages 1-3: rules. Page 4: board; A3 enlargement recommended.

Pages 5-6: one player mat and one flip card per player.

Pages 7-8: print each page twice to make 24 orders.

Pages 9-12: one copy each. Bring pencils and small markers.

Your turn: send or change a route

Take turns clockwise from the starting player. Choose one action, or pass.

A / SEND ONE PACKET

You need an unused token and an unsent order.
1. Choose an order. State its destination IP, /24 network and your default gateway.
2. Reveal the order. Enter your player ID, packet number and current router: R1.
3. Put the token in the R1 waiting area. Do not queue or move it yet.
4. Immediately draw a replacement order to restore your hand to two.
Your action is over. You cannot send again or change a route this turn.

B / USE YOUR ROUTE FLIP CARD

Switch R1's entry for destination D between these next hops:
R2 (10.0.12.2) <-> R4 (10.0.14.2).
The change takes effect immediately and stays until switched again. Do not send a packet this turn. Keep the card; reuse it on a future turn. Other players may spend their action to switch it back. Only this entry can be changed. Use its final state for the forwarding phase.

A shared change affects matching traffic

Every D packet still at R1 is affected, including queued packets owned by other players. Packets already past R1 are not recalled: they use their current router's table.
Resolve multiple switches in player order; the final setting applies. You may change the route or pass even when both your packets are in transit.
This is a manual static-route change, not a fixed direction assigned to an order.

Forward packets after all turns

Each round: act / look up and queue / move / score and advance

1 Look up routes and adjust queues

For each packet, match the order's destination IP in its current router's table. Queued packets with unchanged next hops keep their relative order. Remove packets whose next hop changed. Add rerouted packets and packets in waiting areas to their new queue tails in this round's player order; for one player, packet 1 precedes packet 2. Finish all queue adjustments before moving anything.

2 Release up to two per link

Select the first two packets, or fewer if available, from each of the four link queues. Both directions share that limit. Select all packets first, then move them to their next-hop routers and update their order cards. Each packet crosses at most one link per round. Unselected packets retain their queue positions.

3 Deliver or wait at the new router

At the destination network's router, deliver locally at once: B at R2, C at R3, D at R4. Score the order, discard it and recover the token. Do not draw an extra order. Other moved packets wait at their new router until next round; they cannot move again now.

4 Refill and rotate

When the deck is empty, shuffle the discard pile. If both are empty, wait to refill. At round end, restore short hands to two in the current player order when cards are available. Pass the starting-player marker clockwise. End after round 8 forwarding and scoring; no further delivery is allowed.

EXAMPLE: A D PACKET STILL AT R1

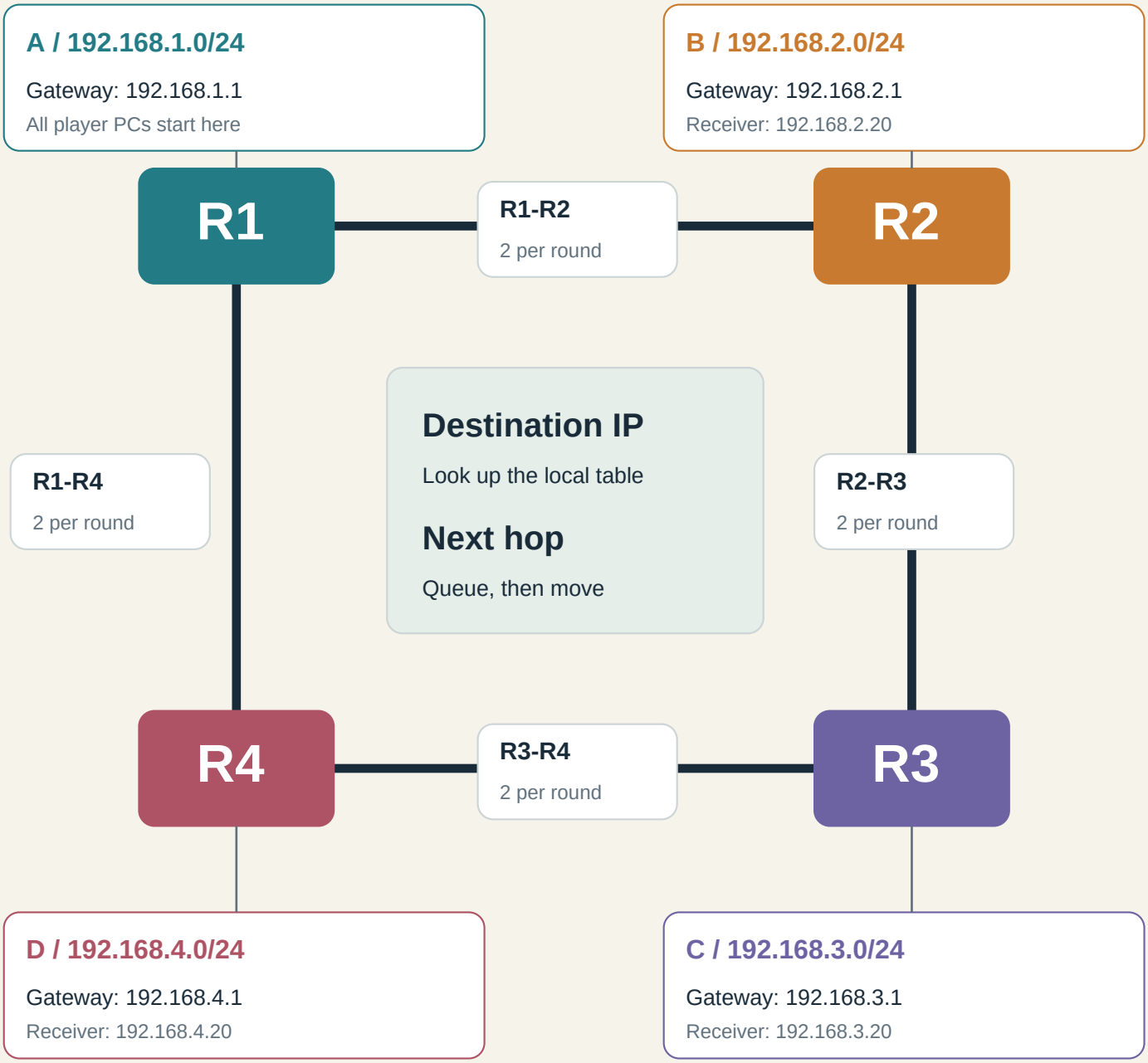
If its next hop changes from R2 to R4, move it from the R1-R2 queue to the tail of R1-R4. A packet already at R2 still follows R2 to R3, then R4. The destination IP stays unchanged. Correct a network-identification mistake without penalty. Players cannot cancel or exchange orders.

Shared game board

Four networks in a ring / Each link carries at most two packets per round

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8

Mark the current round. Put each queue beside its matching link.



Tables: pages 11-12. Deliver locally at B/R2, C/R3 or D/R4.

My company / Player mat

One copy per player / Two unsent orders / At most two packets in transit

Player P_____ Score _____

Source: 192.168.1.____ /24 Gateway: 192.168.1.1

P1=.10 / P2=.20 / P3=.30 / P4=.40 / P5=.50

Unsent order 1

Keep face down.

Draw a replacement when you send it.

Unsent order 2

Keep face down.

Draw a replacement when you send it.

In transit / Packet 1

Keep the order visible.

Update the current router after every move.

On delivery: score, discard the order and recover the token.

In transit / Packet 2

Keep the order visible.

Update the current router after every move.

On delivery: score, discard the order and recover the token.

Keep your flip card beside the mat.

Choose one action: send a packet or use the Route Flip Card.

Changes are public and persist. There is no pending-card effect.

Route Flip Card / Static route

One copy per player / Cut around the card / Reusable / Only the specified entry may change

ROUTE FLIP CARD

Change R1's next hop for D

Destination: 192.168.4.0/24

R2 (10.0.12.2) <-> R4 (10.0.14.2)

Use your turn; do not send a packet.

The change takes effect immediately and stays until switched again.

Keep this card for later turns.

A shared entry affects all matching packets.

A routing change, not an order-specific direction

Use the final table setting at the forwarding phase. Other players may switch it back on their turns. Packets already past R1 are not recalled. All other entries stay fixed, so both allowed states deliver without routing loops.

Record the shared setting

On R1's D row, place a small marker over the active option. Start at R2. Switch by moving the marker once; do not change the order's destination IP.

Delivery orders / 1

Print each of pages 7-8 twice: 24 orders total / Use identical opaque backs / Cut outer borders

ORDER B01 — 3 pts

DESTINATION IP

192.168.2.20

Mask: /24 (255.255.255.0)

Player P____ Packet ____

At: [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3 [ ] R4

Look up the table at each router. Deliver locally.

ORDER B02 — 3 pts

DESTINATION IP

192.168.2.20

Mask: /24 (255.255.255.0)

Player P____ Packet ____

At: [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3 [ ] R4

Look up the table at each router. Deliver locally.

ORDER B03 — 3 pts

DESTINATION IP

192.168.2.20

Mask: /24 (255.255.255.0)

Player P____ Packet ____

At: [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3 [ ] R4

Look up the table at each router. Deliver locally.

ORDER B04 — 3 pts

DESTINATION IP

192.168.2.20

Mask: /24 (255.255.255.0)

Player P____ Packet ____

At: [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3 [ ] R4

Look up the table at each router. Deliver locally.

ORDER C01 — 5 pts

DESTINATION IP

192.168.3.20

Mask: /24 (255.255.255.0)

Player P____ Packet ____

At: [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3 [ ] R4

Look up the table at each router. Deliver locally.

ORDER C02 — 5 pts

DESTINATION IP

192.168.3.20

Mask: /24 (255.255.255.0)

Player P____ Packet ____

At: [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3 [ ] R4

Look up the table at each router. Deliver locally.

Delivery orders / 2

Print each of pages 7-8 twice: 24 orders total / Use identical opaque backs / Cut outer borders

ORDER C03 — 5 pts

DESTINATION IP

192.168.3.20

Mask: /24 (255.255.255.0)

Player P____ Packet ____

At: [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3 [ ] R4

Look up the table at each router. Deliver locally.

ORDER C04 — 5 pts

DESTINATION IP

192.168.3.20

Mask: /24 (255.255.255.0)

Player P____ Packet ____

At: [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3 [ ] R4

Look up the table at each router. Deliver locally.

ORDER D01 — 3 pts

DESTINATION IP

192.168.4.20

Mask: /24 (255.255.255.0)

Player P____ Packet ____

At: [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3 [ ] R4

Look up the table at each router. Deliver locally.

ORDER D02 — 3 pts

DESTINATION IP

192.168.4.20

Mask: /24 (255.255.255.0)

Player P____ Packet ____

At: [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3 [ ] R4

Look up the table at each router. Deliver locally.

ORDER D03 — 3 pts

DESTINATION IP

192.168.4.20

Mask: /24 (255.255.255.0)

Player P____ Packet ____

At: [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3 [ ] R4

Look up the table at each router. Deliver locally.

ORDER D04 — 3 pts

DESTINATION IP

192.168.4.20

Mask: /24 (255.255.255.0)

Player P____ Packet ____

At: [ ] R1 [ ] R2 [ ] R3 [ ] R4

Look up the table at each router. Deliver locally.

Tokens and round reference

Two packet tokens per player / Cut out and place in the queues

P1-1 P1-2

P2-1 P2-2

P3-1 P3-2

P4-1 P4-2

P5-1 P5-2

STARTING PLAYER

CURRENT ROUND

Player IDs identify owners.

Numbers 1 and 2 identify their packets.

Use the labels, not just the colours.

ROUND REFERENCE

1. Each player sends, uses a flip card or passes.
2. Look up routes, adjust queues, then move up to two per link.
3. Score deliveries; other moved packets wait at their new routers.
4. Refill short hands, rotate the starting player and advance.

Learning focus

Destination networks, gateways, table lookups and static routes. Link capacity, rounds and queue rerouting are game abstractions. This version has not been balance-tested with human players; playtest before adjusting order values.

Physical queue strips

Cut outer borders / Place each strip beside its link / Position records waiting order

R1-R2 / FRONT -> BACK (left to right)

Release the first two. Close gaps; new arrivals join at the right.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

R2-R3 / FRONT -> BACK (left to right)

Release the first two. Close gaps; new arrivals join at the right.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

R3-R4 / FRONT -> BACK (left to right)

Release the first two. Close gaps; new arrivals join at the right.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

R1-R4 / FRONT -> BACK (left to right)

Release the first two. Close gaps; new arrivals join at the right.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

Both directions share one queue. Tokens fit the slots at original print size; a physical line also works. Simultaneous arrivals follow this round's player order, then packet number within one player.

Shared routing tables / 1

One copy / Cut outer borders / Shared by all / All destination masks: /24 = 255.255.255.0

R1 ROUTING TABLE

Destination network /24	Next-hop router and adjacent interface IP
A / 192.168.1.0	Local delivery
B / 192.168.2.0	R2 10.0.12.2
C / 192.168.3.0	R2 10.0.12.2
D / 192.168.4.0	R2 10.0.12.2 / R4 10.0.14.2

D next hop: [ ] R2 (initial) [ ] R4

Only this row can change. Mark the active choice.

R2 ROUTING TABLE

Destination network /24	Next-hop router and adjacent interface IP
A / 192.168.1.0	R1 10.0.12.1
B / 192.168.2.0	Local delivery
C / 192.168.3.0	R3 10.0.23.2
D / 192.168.4.0	R3 10.0.23.2

All entries fixed. Local delivery uses no ring-link capacity.

Only the four LAN destinations are shown, not a device's complete routing table.

Shared routing tables / 2

One copy / Cut outer borders / Shared by all / All destination masks: /24 = 255.255.255.0

R3 ROUTING TABLE

Destination network /24	Next-hop router and adjacent interface IP
A / 192.168.1.0	R2 10.0.23.1
B / 192.168.2.0	R2 10.0.23.1
C / 192.168.3.0	Local delivery
D / 192.168.4.0	R4 10.0.34.2

All entries fixed. Local delivery uses no ring-link capacity.

R4 ROUTING TABLE

Destination network /24	Next-hop router and adjacent interface IP
A / 192.168.1.0	R1 10.0.14.1
B / 192.168.2.0	R1 10.0.14.1
C / 192.168.3.0	R3 10.0.34.1
D / 192.168.4.0	Local delivery

All entries fixed. Local delivery uses no ring-link capacity.

Only the four LAN destinations are shown, not a device's complete routing table.